



Immersion And More



The mighty brains over at the Fraunhofer Institute never fail to amaze us. This time, they've come out with, among other things, the world's smallest HD camera and a way to share music that will make DRM redundant while still keeping the money flowing into the record companies' pockets. There was also the 3D display shown here, which doesn't need you to wear any special glasses—just sit in front of it; the two cameras on top sense the distance between your eyes, and the images dished out are accordingly spaced. It also recognises hand gestures, so you can rotate objects that you see, the same way you would touch and rotate a real object.

The aforementioned music sharing system is called Freebies, and will work thus: User A sends a recommendation to User B in the form of a partially encrypted song. User B listens, likes, then buys. User A, then, gets something in return for getting User B to buy the song—a free song, a discount, who knows. Because User A has more to gain by making people buy, he's less tempted to share illegally. Everyone now lives in a happy, DRM-free world where the RIAA isn't after anyone's neck. Sadly, no music store has expressed an interest in this system yet, but we have hopes for it.

Phoenix Delayed

Ever heard of the Commodore Pet? Back in the day, this was the cutting edge of gaming PCs. Now, after being under the radar for so many years, Commodore has returned to what it did best, with its range of über-cool gaming PCs. The specs: an Intel Core 2 QX6600, 4 GB of DDR2 RAM, two 8800 GTX cards with 768 MB of memory each, in SLI, and a total of 650 GB of storage. It also comes with these cool interchangeable panels, which you can buy from their online store. No word on how many banks you'll have to rob to own one, or how they're planning to trump Dell and Alienware at the assembled gaming PC game.

Aside: If you thought racing simulators were boring on the PC, you might try RACE, The WTCC Game, on this simulator that Commodore had set up for visitors—more than just fun.

